

The Revelation of God as Father

The Worship Limb Opened the Revelation of the Father

It has probably been a little over a year now since He started putting the glory limb on in connection with the worship limb. I am finding that all of this is connected with the worship limb. He would not let me pass up. Contained in it was the revelation of the Father, the glory of God, and worship.

Now that He has been unveiling the revelation of God as Father, I think it is probably the hardest thing I have ever tried to explain in the depths of how it affects a person in the spirit.

He started me out by dropping little tidbits and statements of revelation years ago, like with the burned-out preacher's homes. He said they would not need any if they made the transition from God to God the Father.

I hardly knew what I was saying then. I was just saying what I was hearing, with a feeling inside that I knew. I kind of understood what He was talking about, but not enough to teach and preach on it.

How many remember when the Born-Again Trail, the early teaching class, was first born? I thought it might be six months. Also, when I looked down the trail, He said, "Every promise I have ever promised you, every personal promise both from the Word and from Me personally to you, you will find fulfilled on this trail."

After so long unfolding Paul's revelation of the born-again spirit versus the law, and now John's revelation of compassion, love, and who the Father is, I see what I really wanted from God.

The whole reason I stopped here in Tulsa was that I was sent here to receive an outpouring. He gave me this city. It was not long ago, even though it may not look like it right now. I would not be fooled by what I see here or by what appears to be going on around me. You have no idea what activity is taking place in the Spirit. But He said, "I want you to receive an outpouring."

After a little more flesh died on this trail, there was not much else I wanted. When He killed the world in me and killed this and killed that, I did not want much else. There is not much else that makes me very happy. That is where I find the drive to pray: being transformed, understanding what He wants, understanding His plan for my life, and getting the fuel I need to burn when it is hard to go into the closet.

There are times when you know it is a sacrifice and it costs you to go in. But I do not want anything else. It gets easier and easier the more it is cut away.

Knowing Him as Father Creates Trust and Miracle Confidence

This revelation of the Father is getting so unorthodox that it does not run on a common strand with religion. Because it does not, I do not have much to compare it to.

People bounce around and say, "He is my Father," and you have no idea what they are talking about, because in the next moment they are going to pieces. It makes you wonder what kind of father they have.

My father died in Muskogee when I was on television here in Tulsa in my glory days, the airplane days. I was on television here, and undoubtedly it was being aired in Muskogee. My father died in the Veterans Hospital. I think he had cirrhosis of the liver. He drank himself to death. He was a preacher's kid.

Our mother died of cirrhosis of the liver when I was in my late twenties. So I really did not know what to expect when I ventured into this. My brother, my sister, and I were viewed by Grandpa as Everett's kids. He never took the role model you would recognize as a father. He was a disciplinarian without the father. It was like military school: "Drop and give me fifty."

So some of this I do not know from natural comparison. Maybe some people can compare it; I cannot. But it does not matter because I got off the couch a long time ago. I feel no lack. I have no scars. I do not treat my kids mean because my father treated me mean. I got off the couch. Strongholds are gone. They have all been displaced and replaced with peace.

But now that my Father is coming in and revealing Himself to me as my Father, it is another experience. We say, "He is my Father," and I have said that all along. But now that He is unveiling it, His revelation of Himself as Father is coupled together with trust, faith, and all those things that make up confidence. You know that you know He is totally capable of delivering everything He said He would deliver, and I trust Him.

The miracles are coming to a new level. We messed the Gatlinburg meetings up because people were growing teeth. There were holes where teeth had been pulled out, and teeth were coming in. It causes excitement among visitors.

I enjoy stepping up to the batter's plate with so much confidence, knowing He is right there, knowing I have won before I even swing. That is a good feeling. But the only reason you dangle a carrot in front of a mule when you are sitting on its back is so it will run after it. It does not know it is moving the carrot.

There is something out here. It is getting more wonderful by the moment. No wonder He said they would not need burned-out preacher's homes if they made the transition.

Ephesians Directs Worship to God and the Father

Paul revealed Him as the Father. He revealed Him to the Jew as the Father, and revealed the place the law held as opposed to the place God now holds as Father. That is in the teaching, "You must be born again."

Notice how much Paul makes reference to God, and then in the same verse makes reference to Him as Father.

In Ephesians 5:18, as we discovered on the worship limb, of course that is where the Father lives:

"And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess;
but be filled with the Spirit."

Then he told you how:

"Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs,
singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord;
Giving thanks always for all things unto God and the Father
in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ."

Who are you ministering to? Yourself, particularly in your private worship. Speaking to yourselves, ministering to yourself in psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs, singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord.

Part of that worship is giving thanks always. Notice the differentiation: giving thanks always for all things unto God and the Father in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ.

These verses redirected my worship to some degree. After the time I spent breaking into private worship and getting to know Him outside of a service, I would not allow myself anything but statements of adoration. But after these verses came alive, He said to give thanks for all things.

By then I was getting pretty mortified to the world, so it was not hard to give thanks for things like this:

"I worship, praise, and glorify You that You are not a man that You can lie. You have exalted Your Word above Your name. Heaven and earth will pass, but Your Word stands forever. I have what I say. Therefore I am calling myself dead, that I might be able to separate to You all the glory. The lame walk, the blind see, the poor have the gospel preached to them, the dumb speak, and the dead are raised."

I could worship Him for an hour because He said that, and because that is who He is. Giving thanks to God and the Father in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ is not hard to do.

Ephesians 4 says:

"One God and Father of all,
who is above all,
and through all,
and in you all."

That is the mystery of John 17: "I in them, and thou in me." It is all wrapped around being born again.

John 1 Shows the Roles of the Godhead in Creation

To help you understand this a little better, go to John 1:1. John is quoting Genesis 1:1, only he is giving the role of the Godhead in creation. We know each member of the Godhead took a respective role in creation. Genesis simply says, "In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth."

What Genesis 1:1 is really saying is this: in the beginning, God, taking the three respective members who make the one God, took the roles they took for creation. In the beginning, God created the heavens and the earth.

When you say, "I love You, God," you are encompassing the three members who make the one Godhead. When you begin isolating them and say, "I love the mighty Jehovah," He is the One you now know and love as your Father. When you say, "I love the mighty Logos," He is the One you now know and love as Jesus. It is okay to say, "I love You, Holy Spirit." If you get to worshipping His role too much, He directs you back to God and the revelation of Jesus Christ. That is His ministry right now.

In Genesis 1:1, it just says, "In the beginning, God." But John begins to isolate the respective roles they took in creation, and he isolates the second Person of the Godhead as Creator.

We have had to come up with words to describe this part of God's operation. One of those words is anthropomorphism: God assigning characteristics to Himself by which you can understand Him.

Jehovah assigned to Himself "Father," because our life came from Him. He is the Father. The second Person in the Godhead, known for all time as the Word, the Logos, took the role of Son. He was embodied in the human spirit born of God. He is as much deity as humanity, but you have to understand He is all humanity and all deity.

You can understand a father. You can understand a son. God is wanting us to understand that attribute of Himself. He separated Himself from God, just as Jesus is separated from the Word, and He wants you in your dispensation to know Him as Father.

That is supposed to say something to us. It is supposed to say you are covered. It is supposed to say you do not have to take a care and you do not have to have a worry, because you do not just have a father; you have the heavenly Father. He is it. Quit your search. You are going no higher.

He is it.

John 1:1 says:

"In the beginning was the Word,
and the Word was with God,
and the Word was God."

"In the beginning" means before anything had a beginning that you understand to exist in your creation. For God, there is no beginning. This is not talking about His beginning. It is talking about the beginning of your universe and your world.

Before anything had a beginning that you and I understand to exist, the Logos was there. The Logos was with God, and the Logos was God.

John 1:3 says:

"All things were made by him;
and without him was not any thing made that was made."

John 1:10 says:

"He was in the world,
and the world was made by him,
and the world knew him not."

That isolates the second Person. All things were made by Him, the Logos. All the substance for everything that exists came from His person. The fiber in this carpet, the substance it was made from, was created from this Person of the Godhead. Not one single thing was made without Him.

When John says He was with God, the word God there constitutes the other two members of the Godhead. He was one of the members. He was with them, and He was God. "With" means tri-equal. Nothing was diminished. The mighty Holy Spirit took no second place to the mighty Jehovah, and the mighty Logos took no second place to the mighty Jehovah or the mighty Holy Spirit.

In terms you can understand, they all stood rib cage to rib cage, nose to nose, eyes to eyes, face to face, tri-equal with each other in the Godhead. Only for creation did they take the roles you understand them to exist in.

The mighty Logos made everything, and He made Himself responsible for your redemption. In this anthropomorphism, they took these roles, and God wants to reveal Himself to you as your Father, just like Jesus in His glorified humanity has revealed Himself to you as your Redeemer.

Until I get to know Him thoroughly as my Father, I do not think I, or anyone else who does not, will see everything He has for any generation.

Adoption Means Being Born Back Into the Family

When He started unveiling certain things, I needed to bring you up to a certain point. This has been the wildest year I have ever spent. Sometimes I do not even know what is going on in me. I just cannot stop.

I think a man has to get ready for each level of compassion God gives him, or he cannot hold it in his vessel.

In our teaching, we have traced the bloodline from Adam to Jesus. Adam was called the son of God, and Jesus was called the Son of God. Joseph did not touch Mary, but Jesus was attributed to Joseph and the genealogy went all the way back to Adam. Jesus was born from above. That is an assimilation or type of your rebirth.

Jesus said, "That which is born of the flesh is flesh." Your first birth was Adamic; your second birth was from above. In reality, your natural father is no more the father of your new life than Joseph was Jesus' father.

When the Bible talks about you and me being redeemed, it says we are adopted. In order to be adopted, you first had to belong to another family.

I saw something last week that I have not been able to cut into enough words, except that it makes me cry. The best way to understand it is to take your own child. What if your child was put away from you and given to another family, so completely given to them that you could never take him back in that state because he was not able to come back, but you wanted him back?

That is what He called Adam. He did not call Adam anything different than He called Jesus. In Luke 3, the genealogy ends with Adam, the son of God. Both of these men were born of God.

Angels were created outside of God, but not you. When He was through with the angels, He had formed them outside Himself, programmed them, and there they were, ready for full service. They did not start as babies. There was no procreation. Each was created outside of God.

When He came to Adam, He breathed into him the breath of life. God does not breathe. When Nicodemus asked about being born again, Jesus explained the process again with wind, another word for breath. Wherever there is air, men can exist. Where there is no air, they cannot. It is a life factor. That is why He used it to explain the rebirth.

God is able to breathe that breath of life into you. He is able, by the regenerating power of the Holy Spirit, to take the life inside God and cause you to be born of His incorruptible seed, which abides forever. There is no human being anywhere who bows the knee that He is not able to do the same thing in them that He did in Adam, causing their spirit to come alive.

Now take that child who has been put away from you in another family. This other family is so unlike you that they do not even have the same nature. There is not even any way they could really know you. But they had to belong somewhere, because they have to be adopted.

The adoption process will be made complete at the redemption of my body, when I get a glorified body. But right now we have a problem: your child is outside you, belongs to another family, and does not even have your nature or genealogy anymore. He has been thoroughly cut off.

You want him back. How are you going to get him? And when you do get him back, what do you want him to have? Do you want him intact, a full family member with everything he had before he was cut off? Or do you want to mutilate him and bring him back without the attributes of family?

Only God could think of this. Paul said:

"Nevertheless I live;
yet not I,
but Christ liveth in me."

It is the same me. I am the same person I was before I was born again, except now I have been adopted by God, and He has given me His new nature back. This adoption process is heading for completion in the glorified body I will receive.

He started a process to adopt me out of that family, but the way He did it was to cause me to be born back into His family with all the attributes and rights I lost when I was taken out of it. Who could think of anything like that except God?

I live, yet not I. Somehow it is me, yet it is Christ who lives in me. I am His son because His life and nature are back in me. I have been born again.

If you are going to implement those rights now, you have to get to know Him as your Father.

The Father Is How God Reveals Himself to the Born-Again Son

Paul said, "Giving thanks to God and the Father." Most of us know Him better as God. But the part of Him that you come from, He refers to as the Father. You are not deity. You are not supernatural in the sense of being some little god who creates things. The substance of everything that exists comes from the person of God. You are not like that. You are a son of God, but you are not God.

This is why God likes you to refer to Him as your Father. Even though He is God, to you, because you are born of Him, He would like you to address Him as your Father.

Jesus is the second Person in the Godhead, yet He is referred to as the Firstborn of many brethren. In His humanity, He is the Son of God. When He says, "My glory I give unto you," that is the standing He had with His Father. Yet He is as much deity, as much a member of the Godhead, as God who would now like you to know Him as your Father.

Knowing Him as your Father is as supernatural as knowing Jesus as the Firstborn. When you pray, what name do you use to address the Father? You say, "In the name of Jesus." You do not say, "In the name of the deity of Jesus." You say, "In the name of Jesus, the Firstborn who paid the price for me, I am addressing You."

Who are you addressing? You are really addressing the Father. Even though He is as much God as He is your Father, Jesus is as much deity as He is the Firstborn of many brethren. But Jesus prefers that you address Him as the Firstborn because that is who He is to you in redemption.

Who God is to you in redemption is your Father. He would like you to refer to Him as such because you have been born of Him.

You have a better chance of moving the Father than you do God. The Old Testament saints could only know Him as God. You know Him as the Father. You will get more from Him. Treat Him with respect, but know Him as Father.

Jesus Revealed the Father More Than Abstract Deity

What revelation was greatest to Jesus as He walked among men? What a new concept to a Jew who only knew Him as God.

Under the Old Testament, their service to God was called worship. Abraham went to worship God, and that involved offering Isaac. They included service as worship because Old Testament saints had nothing to offer Him unless they offered it through animal blood.

But not you. That is why the Father seeks such to worship Him. All that has been annihilated. You have a spirit and a nature like Him. You have the right to come directly to your Father's presence and worship Him as your Father, because you are a partaker of His divine nature. You have some kind of fellowship He wants. He has been after it, and He has got it done.

Think about John. He was a simple fisherman: "I throw my net; I catch fish." Jesus said, "I will make you fishers of men." Then John is banished to the Isle of Patmos, about a hundred years old, in a penal colony near Turkey, breaking rocks, and receives the mighty book of Revelation with all its symbolism: the bear, the eagle, the dragon, the serpent, and the woman. A simple fisherman receives that mighty revelation.

Here is Jesus walking among us, now seated at the right hand of the Father, the Firstborn of many brethren, covering the church in the priesthood of His glorified humanity. Yet in His deity, all things exist by Him. He walks around in the very sequence of the DNA of the lily He comments on. In His deity, He is where it came from.

If anyone could really teach the lily, it was Him. He said:

"Consider the lilies of the field."

He said, in essence, "Look at the lily. Look at the birds of the air. Solomon in all his glory, in the gold mesh robes he wore as he ascended to his temple to worship his God, with the heavenly utensils of worship, the pots of gold and silver, and the servants hanging on every word of wisdom that came out of his mouth--even the queen of Sheba was stunned. Yet see that lily? In My deity, I created the sequence that dressed it like that. It is in the field today and tomorrow will be baked in a woman's oven. What makes you think your heavenly Father will not clothe you?"

He walked around teaching, "Your Father, your Father, your Father." Why? Very little is known about His deity. We know from Hebrews that God created the worlds by Him. We know He was Creator in deity, but we know very little about Jesus' deity. We know a lot about His humanity, because that is who He revealed to us.

In the same way, God's greatest revealing to you is as the Father. You have been born of Him. Jesus is the mighty Logos and Christ. The Father is mighty Jehovah.

Who is smart enough to have you reborn and yet not lose you? Jesus told Nicodemus, "You must be born of water and of the Spirit." He was answering the question. That which is born of flesh is flesh. Adamic man reproduces himself. But your next birth is from above.

Paul said, "Nevertheless I live; yet not I, but Christ liveth in me." I have been reborn back into God's family. He got me back. He is my Father. I am going to learn to deal with Him as my Father.

I do not deal much with the deity of Jesus. I deal a lot with the Firstborn humanity of Jesus. I use His name a lot to the Father. But I think I am going to get a whole lot more done approaching Him as my Father, for I have been born again.

Did I use that in prayer before? Yes, but not with the faith I have now.

Maybe we ought to worship Him a little bit. How many got close for that time? I tell you, you got close for a minute there. How about standing up and lifting your hands?